Since both the reactions take place simultaneously, the inter conversion of electrical and chemical energy in electrochemical cells involves a **redox reaction.**

(c) Types of Electrochemical Cell

Based on the nature of the energy conversion, electrochemical cells are broadly classified as below.

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Galvanic Cell

- It is an electrochemical cell which converts chemical energy into electrical energy i.e. it produces electricity from chemical reactions.
- It consists of two half cells namely **anodic half-cell** and **cathodic half-cell.**
- In anodic half-cell, the anode is in contact with its electrolyte whereas in cathodic half-cell, the cathode is in contact with its electrolyte.
- The anode and cathode are connected by a conductor wire. The electrolytes of half-cells are connected through a tube containing a saturated salt solution. It is called **salt bridge**. Thus in galvanic cell, both the half-cells are kept separately but stay connected electrically.

How does a galvanic cell produce electricity?

At anode, oxidation takes place which releases electrons. These electrons are attracted by cathode and hence the electrons flowing from anode to cathode are gained in reduction reaction. As long as the redox reaction proceeds, there is a flow of electrons and hence electricity.

Activity 1

With the help of your teacher, construct the galvanic cell using lemon and potato. Identity their anode, cathode and electrolyte.

Electrolytic Cell

- It is an electrochemical cell which converts electrical energy into chemical energy i.e. in electrolytic cells, electricity is used to bring about chemical reactions.
- Here, both anode and cathode are in contact with same electrolyte and thus the half-cells are not separated. As seen in galvanic cells, electrolytic cell also involves redox reaction.

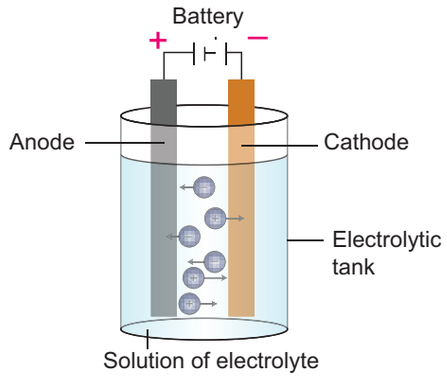


Figure 16.2 Electrolytic Cell

We get electricity from galvanic cells. But electrolytic cells use electricity. Then how are they useful?

In electrolytic cells, when electricity is passed to the electrolyte, it dissociates into its constituent ions. These ions undergo redox reaction forming the respective elements. This phenomenon is called **Electrolysis.** So, electrolysis is a process by which an electrolyte is decomposed into its constituent elements by passing electricity through its aqueous solution or fused (molten) state.

(b) Significance of electrochemistry

The subject of electro chemistry is of great significance. Some of its applications are given below.

i. It has been used to discover important technical processes for the production and purification of non-ferrous metals, and for the electro- synthesis of organic compounds.

ii. Electrochemistry is used to predict whether a particular reaction will occur or not.

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